

Human Resources

Question Booklet

Past HSC and trial questions from your Drive, screenshotted exactly as they appeared and sorted by syllabus dot point.

SECTION	QUESTIONS			
Section A — Multiple choice	Q1–18	18 questions	18 marks	p. 3
Section B — Short answer	Q19–45	27 questions	92 marks	p. 8
Section C — 20-mark questions	Q46–47	2 questions	40 marks	p. 24

How to use this booklet

1. **Section A** – multiple choice: circle one answer (about 1.5 min each).
2. **Section B** – short answers, grouped by the syllabus in the same order as your notes. Each question shows its source paper, marks and the dot point it tests. Write on the lines (about 1.8 min per mark).
3. **Section C** – the 20-mark questions are on the last pages: plan in the box, then write in full on separate paper.
4. Check every answer in the matching **Answer Booklet** – question numbers are identical.
5. Tick off the **Syllabus map** (next page) as you master each dot point.

Syllabus map

Every dot point in the syllabus (as in your notes) and the questions in this booklet that test it. Tick each one off once you can answer its questions confidently.

CODE	SYLLABUS DOT POINT	QUESTIONS	✓
H1a	Strategic role of human resource management	Q1, Q19, Q34	☐
H1b	Interdependence (HR) with other key business functions	Q2, Q20	☐
H1c	Outsourcing – HR functions; using contractors – domestic and global	Q3, Q21, Q22	☐
H2a	Stakeholders – employers, employees, employer associations, unions, government organisations, society	Q4, Q6, Q23, Q31	☐
H2b	Legal – employment contract (common law, minimum employment standards/NES, awards, enterprise agreements, other employment contracts); WHS and workers compensation; anti-discrimination and EEO	Q5, Q6, Q24, Q25, Q26, Q27	☐
H2c	Economic influences	Q7, Q28	☐
H2d	Technological influences	Q29, Q31	☐
H2e	Social influences – changing work patterns, living standards	Q8, Q30, Q31	☐
H2f	Ethics and corporate social responsibility (HR)	Q32	☐
H3a	Processes – acquisition	Q33, Q34, Q38, Q46	☐
H3b	Processes – development	Q9, Q33, Q34, Q39, Q46	☐
H3c	Processes – maintenance	Q10, Q34	☐
H3d	Processes – separation	Q11, Q29, Q35	☐
H4a	Leadership style	Q12, Q36	☐
H4b	Job design – general or specific tasks	Q13, Q37	☐
H4c	Recruitment – internal or external, general or specific skills	Q21, Q27, Q38, Q46	☐
H4d	Training and development – current or future skills	Q9, Q14, Q39, Q47	☐
H4e	Performance management – developmental or administrative	Q15, Q40	☐
H4f	Rewards – monetary and non-monetary, individual or group, performance pay	Q16, Q37, Q41, Q47	☐
H4g	Global – costs, skills, supply	Q29	☐
H4h	Workplace disputes – causes; resolution (negotiation, mediation, grievance procedures, courts and tribunals)	Q17, Q23, Q42, Q43, Q47	☐
H5a	Effectiveness indicators – corporate culture, benchmarking key variables, staff turnover, absenteeism, accidents, levels of disputation, worker satisfaction	Q18, Q43, Q44, Q45, Q47	☐

Section A — Multiple choice

Circle the best answer. About 1.5 minutes each.

Q1 Newington Trial 2023 · Q3 H1a · Strategic role of HRM

3. Which of the following are BOTH key functions of human resource management?

A.	Maximising product output	Minimising product defects
B.	Maximising shareholder value	Minimising tax liabilities
C.	Maximising market share	Minimising customer complaints
D.	Maximising employee productivity	Minimising workplace disputes

Q2 SIC Trial 2024 · Q1 H1b · Interdependence F1c · Interdependence

1 Budgeting for the acquisition of staff needs is an example of interdependence between which of the following business functions?

- A. Finance and marketing
- B. Marketing and operations
- C. Finance and human resources
- D. Operations and human resources

Q3 Roseville Trial 2023 · Q4 H1c · Outsourcing

4 An Australian software company pays a software developer to complete programing work for a new computer game they are making. The software developer completes the work from their home in Lebanon and is then paid a fee in exchange for this work. The developer then moves onto another project for a different company.

In this scenario, the worker in Lebanon is

- (A) a global contractor.
- (B) a domestic contractor.
- (C) a full-time permanent employee of the Australian company.
- (D) a part-time permanent employee of the Australian company.

Q4**Newington Trial 2023 · Q12****H2a · Stakeholders**

12. The Teacher's Federation of NSW is an organisation which seeks to improve the conditions of employment for its members. Which of the following workplace stakeholders is it?
- A. Employer
 - B. Employee
 - C. Employer association
 - D. Trade Union
-

Q5**2020 HSC · Q12****H2b · Legal**

- 12 A NSW employer develops a return to work plan in consultation with an insurer and an injured employee.
- Which legislation requires the employer to undertake this action?
- A. *Fair Work Act 2009* (Cth)
 - B. *Workers Compensation Act 1987* (NSW)
 - C. *Work Health and Safety Act 2011* (NSW)
 - D. *Australian Human Rights Commission Act 1986* (Cth)
-

Q6**Abbotsleigh Trial 2024 · Q2****H2b · Legal****H2a · Stakeholders**

2. Which of the following organisations is responsible for applying the Better Off Overall (BOOT) test to enterprise agreements?
- a) Fair Work Act 2009
 - b) Fair Work Commission
 - c) Australian Securities and Investment Commission
 - d) Australian Council of Trade Unions
-

Q7**Independent Trial 2024 · Q17****H2c · Economic**

- 17 An economy is experiencing a period of high economic growth during an expansion phase in the business cycle.
- Which of the following changes in human resource management strategies is most likely to occur?
- A. A decrease in non-financial rewards
 - B. A decrease in the availability of suitably skilled employees
 - C. A decrease in the number of employees recruited and retained
 - D. An increase in the number of redundancy packages offered to employees
-

Q8**SIC Trial 2024 · Q7****H2e · Social**

7 A business currently allows employees to work from home two days a week out of five.

Which influence is impacting the HR decision of this business?

- A. Social
- B. Legal
- C. Parental
- D. Economic

Q9**Newington Trial 2023 · Q16****H3b · Development****H4d · Training & development**

16. Which of the following best describes the process of induction?

- A. Hiring a new employee
- B. Introducing a new employee to the business culture
- C. Providing reward to high performing employees
- D. An employee signing an employment contract

Q10**Roseville Trial 2024 · Q10****H3c · Maintenance**

10 A software development company has recently implemented several initiatives to improve employee satisfaction and retention. These initiatives include regular performance reviews, ongoing training programs, comprehensive health, and wellness benefits, and creating a positive work environment.

Which of the human resources processes is demonstrated by the company's initiatives?

- (A) Acquisition
- (B) Training and Development
- (C) Maintenance
- (D) Separation

Q11**2022 HSC · Q2****H3d · Separation**

2 Which of the following is a type of voluntary separation in the workplace?

- A. Dismissal
- B. Layoff
- C. Resignation
- D. Retrenchment

Q12 2019 HSC · Q3 **H4a · Leadership style**

3 A business in crisis needs to make immediate and timely decisions in order to survive.

Which leadership style does a manager of this business need to adopt?

- A. Autocratic
- B. Bureaucratic
- C. Democratic
- D. Laissez-faire

Q13 2012 Trial (from your MC bank) · Q4 **H4b · Job design**

4 The human resources department has been given the task of developing and specifying the activities of new employees.

Which of the following best describes this function?

- (A) Job rotation
- (B) Job design
- (C) Recruitment
- (D) Induction

Q14 2020 HSC · Q1 **H4d · Training & development**

1 Which row of the table shows benefits of both staff training and staff development?

	<i>Staff training</i>	<i>Staff development</i>
A.	Increase staff skills	Increased staff turnover
B.	Increase staff skills	Retain experienced staff
C.	Decrease in workplace accidents	Increased staff turnover
D.	Decrease in workplace redundancies	Retain experienced staff

Q15 Knox Trial 2023 · Q16 **H4e · Performance management**

16 Weiling Supermarkets conducts annual appraisals of staff. The purpose of this is to plan for collective staff training needs in the future.

Which of the following best describes the type of performance management strategy being used?

- A. Developmental
- B. Individual
- C. Administrative
- D. Group

- 6** All staff in a business participate equally in a profit-sharing scheme.

Which row of the table correctly identifies this reward strategy?

	<i>Reward</i>	<i>Staff</i>
A.	Monetary	Group
B.	Monetary	Individual
C.	Non-monetary	Group
D.	Non-monetary	Individual

- 10** What is the common sequence for resolving workplace disputes?

- A. Mediation, negotiation, involvement of courts and tribunals
- B. Negotiation, mediation, involvement of courts and tribunals
- C. Involvement of courts and tribunals, negotiation, mediation
- D. Negotiation, involvement of courts and tribunals, mediation

Use the following information to answer Questions 17 and 18.

The table compares four businesses on an annual basis.

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
Absenteeism (average per employee)	8	5	8	5
Accidents per 500 employees	4	2	2	4
% of staff turnover	11	9	9	11
Average output per employee	10	14	10	14

- 18** Which business is likely to be managing its human resources most effectively?

- A. *A*
- B. *B*
- C. *C*
- D. *D*

Section B — Short answer

Grouped by the five parts of the HR syllabus. Aim for about 1.8 minutes per mark.

1. Role of human resource management

H1a Strategic role of human resource management

Q19

Abbotsleigh Trial 2023 · Question 24 (a)

H1a · Strategic role of HRM

2 marks

a) Outline the strategic role of the human resource function. (2 marks)

H1b Interdependence (HR) with other key business functions

Q20 Abbotsleigh Trial 2023 · Question 24 (c)

H1b · Interdependence

F1c · Interdependence

4 marks

The table below contains data concerning a business in 2021 and 2022.

	2021	2022
Human Resources costs	\$2 600 000	\$2 000 000
Training expenditure per employee	\$1900	\$1500
Absenteeism per employee	10 days	14 days
Accidents per 1000 employees	50	30
Number of strike days	2	10
Staff turnover	15%	10%

- c) Using the data, analyse the interdependence between human resources management and financial management in this business. (4 marks)

H1c Outsourcing – HR functions; using contractors – domestic and global

Q21 2021 HSC · Question 23 (b)

H1c · Outsourcing

H4c · Recruitment

2 marks

- (b) Why might a business use a contractor to recruit staff?

2

- (a) Outline ONE disadvantage of outsourcing human resources functions.

2

2. Key influences

H2a Stakeholders – employers, employees, employer associations, unions, government organisations, society

- (a) Outline the role of ONE external stakeholder who represents the interests of employees in workplace disputes.

2

Q24 2019 HSC · Question 23 (b) **H2b · Legal**

4 marks

- (b) Distinguish between awards and enterprise agreements.

4

Q25 2022 HSC · Question 22 (b) **H2b · Legal**

3 marks

- (b) Outline how the minimum employment standards protect employees in Australia. Use examples in your answer.

3

Q26 2023 HSC · Question 22 (a) **H2b · Legal**

2 marks

- (a) What is the purpose of Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) legislation?

2

- (b) The advertisement for a store manager is shown.

3



Teddy Bear Store

Est. 1990

Teddy Bear Store aims to bring joy to children.

We are looking for a Store Manager. If you are interested, please contact us.

<u>Role:</u>	<u>Responsibilities:</u>	<u>General information:</u>
– Manage a team of 8 staff members	– Organise inventory	– \$65 000 salary
– Manage day-to-day operations	– Train staff	– Union membership not permitted
	– Assist customers	– No superannuation included

Outline TWO human resource issues found in this advertisement.

H2c Economic influences

Q28 HRM Exam Prep · Question (d)

H2c · Economic

4 marks

Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

(d) Explain the impact of a recession on Mango Airlines human resource management. **4**

H2d Technological influences

Q29 2020 HSC · Question 21 (c)

H2d · Technological

H4g · Global HR

H3d · Separation

4 marks

(c) Explain how technological influences and globalisation can lead to a company reducing staff numbers. Support your answer with relevant examples. **4**

Q30 2023 HSC · Question 22 (c) H2e · Social

5 marks

- (c) The table shows labour force participation rates for males and females in Australia, 1981–2021. **5**

<i>Year</i>	<i>Males</i>	<i>Females</i>
1981	78%	44%
2001	73%	55%
2021	71%	62%

Explain the social influences that have contributed to the changing labour force participation rates in the period 1981–2021.

- (c) In recent times governments have imposed restrictions on businesses such as lockdowns, social distancing and the movement of people. As a result, businesses have changed the way their employees work and communicate with each other.

6

Discuss the possible implications of these influences on human resource management.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

H2f Ethics and corporate social responsibility (HR)

Q32 Independent Trial 2024 · Question 24 (b)

H2f · Ethics & CSR

O2b · CSR

4 marks

- (b) Discuss TWO benefits for business of embracing corporate social responsibilities and ethical practices.

4

3. Processes of human resource management

H3a Processes – acquisition

Q33 2022 HSC · Question 22 (d)

H3a · Acquisition

H3b · Development

3 marks

- (d) Explain the importance of carrying out an induction program for new employees.

3

Q34

Reddam Trial 2024 · Question 23 (c)

H3a · Acquisition

H3b · Development

H3c · Maintenance

4 marks

- (c) Explain how a business can use TWO human resources management processes to achieve a competitive advantage.

4

H3d Processes – separation**Q35**

2020 HSC · Question 21 (b)

H3d · Separation

4 marks

- (b) Distinguish between voluntary and involuntary separation.

4

4. Strategies in human resource management

H4a Leadership style

Q36 Newington Trial 2023 · Question 21 (a)

H4a · Leadership style

2 marks

(a) Identify TWO ways that leadership style can affect employee performance in a business. 2

H4b Job design – general or specific tasks

Q37 Practice question · written for this booklet

H4b · Job design

H4f · Rewards

4 marks

A call centre is redesigning its customer service roles. Some staff will handle only one type of enquiry (specific tasks), while others will be trained to handle a wide range of enquiries (general tasks).

Distinguish between general and specific job design, and explain how ONE of these approaches could improve employee performance at the call centre.

No past-paper question on this dot point was found in your papers, so this one was written in HSC style.

Use the following information to answer the question below

5

Raj owns a business that designs security software. His business is rapidly expanding due to the increase in companies allowing their employees to work from home. Raj needs to increase his workforce to keep up with his demand. The work is complicated and requires excellent knowledge of coding and software design.

Due to the expansion, Raj requires more employees in management roles.

(c) Discuss the strategy of internal recruitment for Raj.

H4d Training and development – current or future skills

Q39 HRM Exam Prep · Question (c)

H4d · Training & development

H3b · Development

3 marks

Mango airlines is a large business with over 1200 staff. Due to COVID19 and the current recession in the economy, demand for flights has decreased. Management of the airline are currently unsure how best to manage their human resources during this period.

- (c) Discuss ONE training and development strategy Mango airlines could use to train and develop its staff. 3

H4e Performance management – developmental or administrative

Q40 2022 HSC · Question 22 (c)

H4e · Performance management

3 marks

- (c) How are performance appraisals of employees beneficial to employers? 3

H4f Rewards – monetary and non-monetary, individual or group, performance pay

Q41 Reddam Trial 2023 · Question 23 (b) **H4f · Rewards**

3 marks

- (b) Explain ONE advantage of using group rewards rather than individual rewards in human resource management. **3**

H4h Workplace disputes – causes; resolution (negotiation, mediation, grievance procedures, courts and tribunals)

Q42 Newington Trial 2023 · Question 21 (b) **H4h · Workplace disputes**

3 marks

- (b) Describe the role of grievance procedures in human resource management. **3**

HiFashion is a fast fashion retail store with 40 stores located around Australia and employ 200 staff. Management is concerned with the reduction in productivity and staff feedback it has received. Staff cited rewards, leadership style and dispute resolution methods as key to their dissatisfaction.

Extract of data:

Indicator	2021	2022
Staff turnover	10%	20%
Employee satisfaction	80%	65%
Number of disputes	10 per year	25 per year

- (a) Explain how HiFashion could implement TWO appropriate dispute resolution methods that would reduce the current number of disputes.

4

5. Effectiveness of human resource management

H5a Effectiveness indicators – corporate culture, benchmarking key variables, staff turnover, absenteeism, accidents, levels of disputation, worker satisfaction

- (a) Outline how corporate culture can affect staff turnover.

2

Use the following information to answer Question 24 (c).

The table below contains data for a business between 2022 and 2023.

	2022	2023
Absenteeism per employee	18 days	7 days
Number of disputes	12	5
Training expenditure per employee	\$2 100	\$4 400
Staff turnover	5	11

(c) Evaluate the effectiveness of human resources management at this business. 5

Section C — 20-mark questions

A business report and an essay. Plan in the box, then write on separate paper (about 35 minutes each).

Q46 2019 HSC · Question 25

H3a · Acquisition

H3b · Development

F4b · Working capital management

20 marks

A business, Roo's Outback Eatery Pty Ltd, is opening an additional restaurant in NSW. They plan to position the restaurant as an exclusive restaurant specialising in modern Australian food with quality customer service. The owners require assistance with the following:

- the acquisition and development of suitable staff
- additional funds for the day-to-day running of the business
- the close monitoring of working capital.

You have been hired as a consultant to write a report for the owners. In your report:

- discuss methods this business could use in the acquisition and development of staff
- recommend TWO appropriate working capital management strategies for this business.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Evaluate human resource strategies used to achieve **THREE** indicators of effective human resource management.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.